

ANDREAS GAME

Social Gaming Concept

Concept Brief / Vision Document

**A scheduled co-op competition built around one idea:
bring a fragmented friend group back together for one intense
shared gaming moment.**

This is not a final game design. It captures the problem, the player experience, the non-negotiable design principles, and the first gameplay direction.

1. Why This Game Exists

The starting problem is not a missing genre. It is a social problem.

Friend groups still want to game together, but their gaming lives are fragmented. One person may play League competitively, another plays WoW, another plays Fortnite, and another only has one or two evenings per week. Adults also have work, relationships, families and different schedules.

Most multiplayer games punish this difference. The person who plays 30 hours per week becomes stronger, more knowledgeable or more mechanically advanced than the person who can only play occasionally.

The game is therefore not trying to become everyone's "main game."

The ambition is to become "the game our group plays together." A scheduled social ritual - closer to modern LAN-night energy - where competitive and casual players can coexist inside the same team and both still matter.

Core Promise

Five friends. One unfamiliar challenge. Limited time.

Everybody matters. Nobody can carry alone.

2. The Player Fantasy

The fantasy is not primarily about being a powerful hero. It is about being part of a group that has to understand a problem, communicate, improvise and execute together under pressure.

- Everyone is on Discord and actively communicating.
- The group is yelling instructions, making mistakes, laughing and adapting.
- One person's action genuinely enables the rest of the group to proceed.
- A strong competitive player cannot simply carry four weaker players.
- A casual player is not reduced to a meaningless supporting role.
- The team's real skill is coordination, quick understanding, critical thinking and execution.

3. The Friday-Night Experience

The game is imagined as a scheduled event rather than an always-on grind. A team chooses or registers for a live session - for example Friday 21:00 - and organizes around it.

Before the Event

- The player opens a familiar competitive-style lobby, closer in feeling to Counter-Strike or League of Legends.
- There is a friends list and a party invite system.
- The team gathers in the lobby and locks in.
- One minute before the event starts, the party locks and a visible 60-second countdown begins.
- The actual challenge is intentionally unknown.

At 21:00

The team is dropped into an unfamiliar environment with a live timer. The first minutes are about orientation: reading clues, testing a temporary role kit, understanding the map, and reacting to whatever begins happening.

The experience should feel like the whole group is solving something live, not executing a strategy they practiced all week.

What Success Feels Like

A stage clear should create the simple social reaction: "First one down. Good job boys. Let's go." Then the team breathes, roles change, and the next unfamiliar challenge begins.

What Failure Feels Like

Failure should hurt competitively, but not make the night meaningless. A team may have a limited number of fails or attempts. Even after competitive elimination, continuing or completing content can still provide value - for example an in-game benefit such as a free fail attempt in a future run.

Importantly, the game does not need to own the entire evening. If a team plays from 21:00 to 22:45, gets eliminated, laughs about the run, and then splits into LoL, WoW, Fortnite or logs off, the social mission has already succeeded: the game created the moment that brought the group together.

4. Non-Negotiable Design Principles

Competitive + Casual Coexistence

Both player types must contribute inside the same run. Difficulty should come from teamwork, interpretation and execution - not only mechanical mastery.

Everyone Plays Every Role

No permanent healer, tank or DPS identity. Roles rotate between stages, and a player cannot simply repeat the same role while others rotate.

Every Role Has Real Impact

Every player should have a required responsibility. There should be no low-impact job that merely follows the stronger players.

Simple Temporary Kits

A role should use a small, readable toolkit - e.g. Shield / Charge / Grab / Taunt - rather than 10+ abilities that require long-term mastery.

Kits Belong to the Challenge

Abilities can change completely from event to event. This week's healer may have Heal + Speed Boost; next week's equivalent role may work differently.

Unknown Content

The team should not know the exact challenge in advance. The competition is partly about understanding the situation quickly together.

No Weekly Grind Advantage

The game should avoid a progression system where one player gains a decisive power advantage by playing every day.

Team Failure Is Real

One person's mistake can wipe the group. The tension comes from genuine interdependence.

5. Gameplay Direction

The current gameplay direction is best described as a cooperative puzzle disguised as an action game.

The visual language may borrow from MOBAs or MMO dungeons - tank, healer, DPS, mage, bosses, movement and abilities - but the objective is not traditional MMO combat. The encounter is a sequence of interdependent responsibilities.

Example Encounter

Moment	Team Requirement
1. Fire Breath	The boss prepares a lethal fire attack. The tank must raise a shield and the rest of the party must move behind it.
2. Reposition	Seconds later the boss targets the closest player, forcing the team to move correctly rather than staying stacked.
3. Blue Orbs	Two separate blue objects appear. Two players must collect and transport them before they explode and wipe the party.
4. Support Under Pressure	The orb carriers are slowed or otherwise vulnerable. The healer must keep the party alive while using a movement-speed ability on the carriers.
5. Combined Execution	The difficulty comes from the team understanding who has which responsibility and executing the sequence in sync.

Critical rule: this encounter logic is not a permanent rule set. The next event can have different roles, different abilities, different objectives and a completely different way of thinking.

What the Game Is Testing

- Can the group understand unfamiliar mechanics quickly?
- Can each player communicate what they see and what their role can do?
- Can stronger players help weaker players without simply replacing them?
- Can the team stay synchronized under a timer and limited failures?
- Can five individual players behave like one unit?

6. Competitive Event Layer

The live-event layer is inspired by the feeling of large synchronized competitions: many teams enter during the same window, everybody is under time pressure, and the field narrows as stages continue.

One possible structure is a sequence of timed qualification windows. The first challenge may allow 30 minutes, the next 25, then 20, then 15. Teams that complete a stage in time progress to the next.

The exact tournament structure is not final. What matters at concept stage is the emotion: tonight's run feels like an event, not simply another queue.

7. What Persists - and What Should Not

Permanent power progression is currently considered dangerous because it recreates the original problem: the friend who plays more becomes stronger than the friend who only joins on scheduled nights.

Persistence should therefore lean toward group history, achievement, access, cosmetics, event records or earned advantages that do not destroy competitive fairness. One early idea is that even an eliminated team can earn a limited future benefit - such as a free fail attempt - by continuing to complete content.

8. Ideas Parked for Later

These are intentionally not part of the core game definition yet, but they belong to the broader vision:

- Headline real-world prizes for top finishers, such as gaming hardware.
- Smaller rewards or 'loser bracket' prizes such as Steam gift cards.
- Brand sponsorships if event participation becomes large enough.
- Global participation counts, live rankings and large-scale event spectacle.
- Long-term team identity, history, badges and records.

9. The Obsession

The game should be judged first by the room it creates, not by the feature list.

The desired scene is four or five friends on Discord, all paying attention because every person is needed. They are yelling, blaming, laughing, learning, panicking and celebrating together.

"SHIELD!"

"GET BEHIND ME!"

"WHO HAS THE BLUE BALL?"

"SPEED ME! SPEED ME!"

"NOOO - WHO MOVED?"

If that feeling works, the deeper systems can be built around it. If that feeling does not work, no amount of progression, prizes, matchmaking or marketing will rescue the concept.

10. First Prototype Goal

Do not build the game. Build one proof of the feeling.

- 4-5 players.
- One ugly test arena.
- One unfamiliar cooperative encounter.
- Four or five simple temporary kits.
- A 10-15 minute timer.
- Limited failures / restart.
- No accounts, progression, global tournament, cosmetics or polished art required.

The first test is simple: Are the players communicating? Is every person contributing? Do mistakes create tension without feeling unfair? Do they laugh? Do they immediately want another attempt?

FIRST MILESTONE

**5 FRIENDS | 1 ENCOUNTER | 15 MINUTES | EVERYONE
MATTERS**